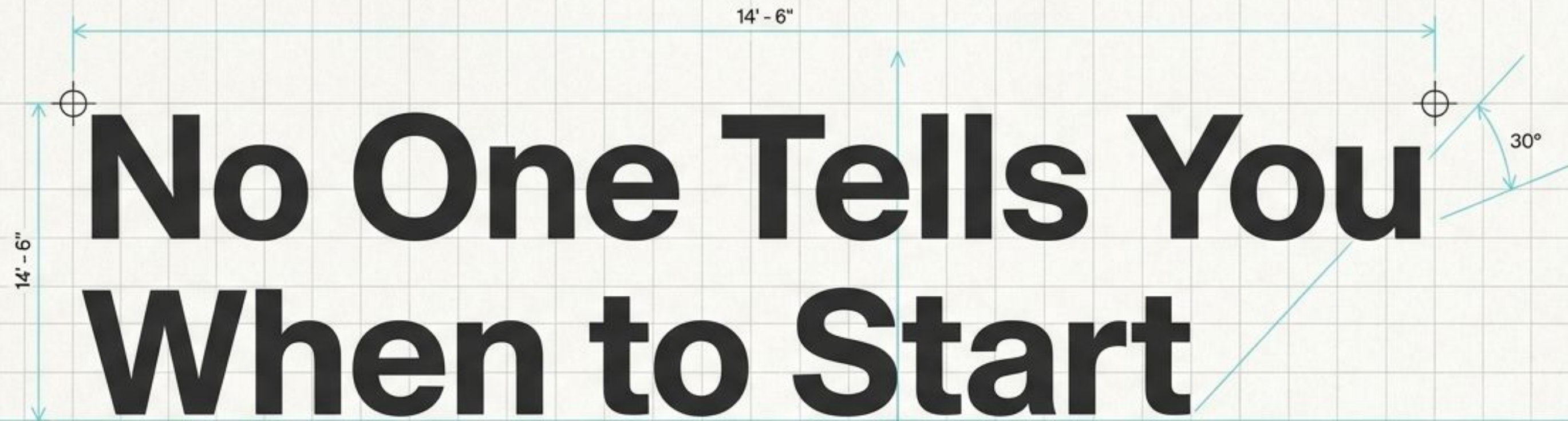
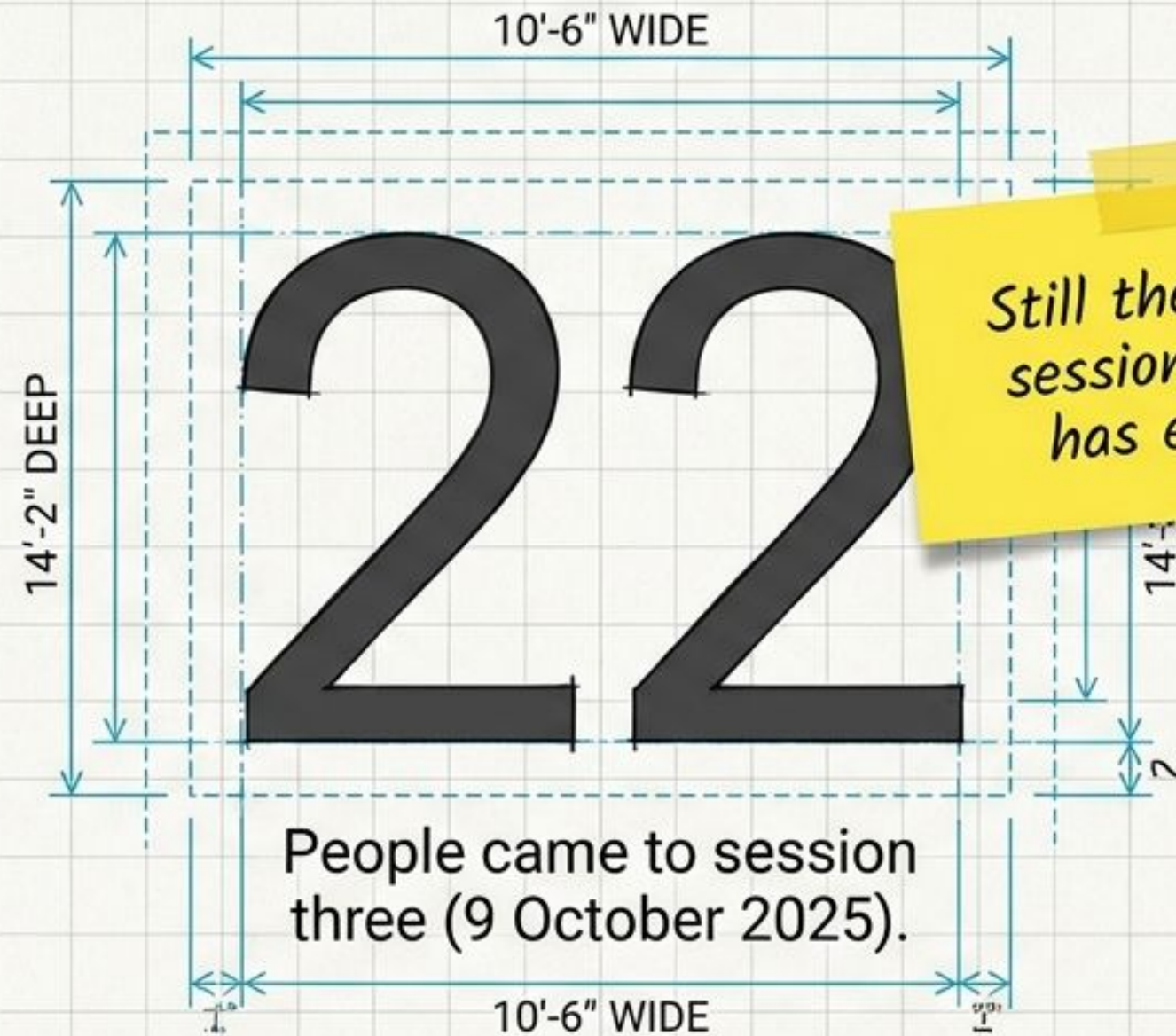




No One Tells You When to Start

On contributing your way into AI safety and governance, before anyone is watching

AUTION				
Mariana Hungria Women4AISafety 9 September 2026				
	SHEET 1	PROJECT	SHEET	GATE
				REVISION
	SHEET 1	PROJECT	SHEET	ENGINEER



Nobody was watching. Nothing about it looked like it was going to work.

THE BASELINE



Linguist.
Mid-career.

Not a lawyer.
Not an engineer.



THE OBSTACLES



Imposter
Syndrome.

Lack of time.



THE BLUEPRINT

The Cheap Test:

**START
BUILDING.**

Weighted-factor ranking:

1. Community Builder
2. Career Mentor
3. Researcher

The Founder Myth



Wait for an invitation.
Build an entire community
from scratch by yourself.

The Contributor Reality

Christen Rao started the AI Governance Club. Not me.

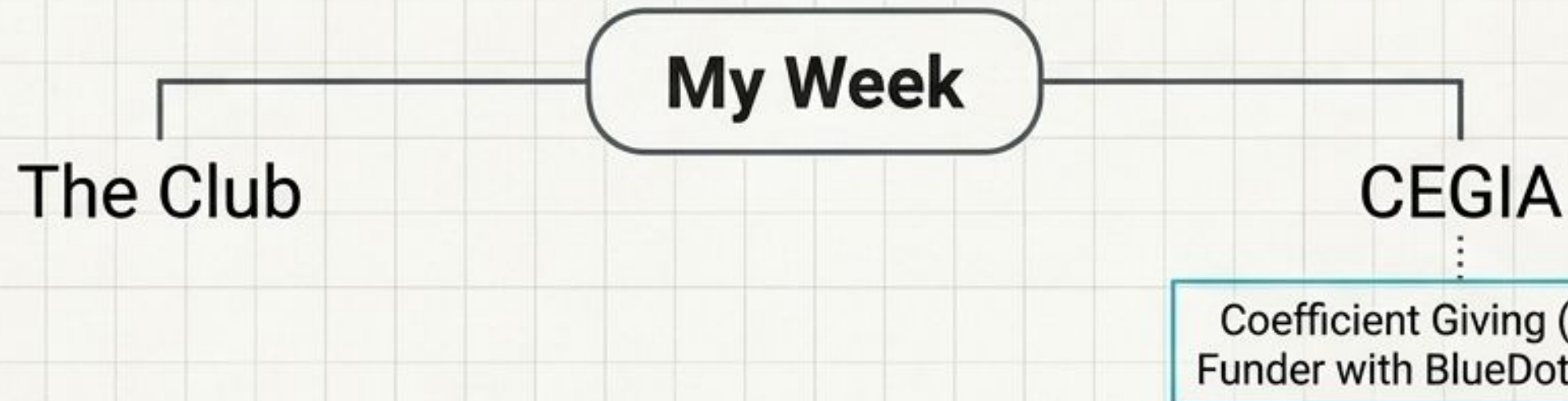


She asked for volunteers.

- 1 → Show up on day one as an attendee.
- 2 → Send a 4-minute message offering to help with anything needed.
- 3 → She says yes.

That message is the single most useful thing I have done in this field.

The other half of the week



Proof of how small this ecosystem is.

This pivot is not finished.

I am not standing here as someone who arrived. I cannot tell you how to get hired. The process is long, competitive, and I am in the middle of it myself.

What I can tell you about **is the part that comes before the application—the part most people skip.**

Attendance Growth & Current State



Current State

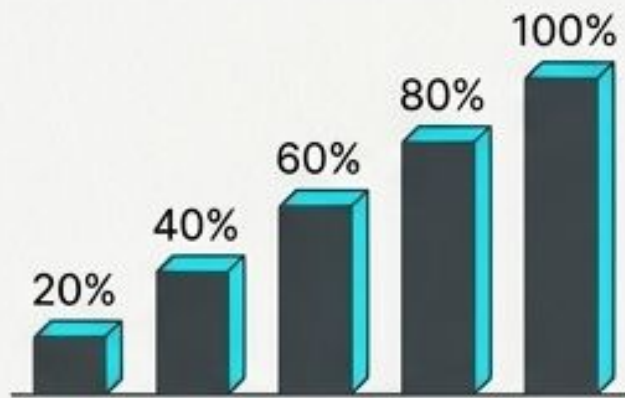
42 sessions total.

34 consecutive weekly sessions.

1,000+ unique people.

2 continents.
Volunteer-started, now part-funded by BlueDot.

Attendance Growth (The Marketing Number)



How many people show up.
Easily manipulated, highly visible.

Returning Rate (The Community Number)



How many people come back.
The true measure of an audience
becoming a community.

Engagement numbers
≠ Impact numbers.

We are building the
measurement for
impact now.

Three-Step Workflow for AI Impact

1

Get the Context

BlueDot Impact's courses are the most recognized entry point (and free).

The capstone matters more than the content—it is usually your first piece of public work.

2

Show Up Weekly

Reading alone isn't enough.

Consistent attendance builds the working vocabulary, reveals live disagreements, and maps who is actually doing what. (The AI Governance Club is just one option).

3

Make One Small Public Thing

A summary of a paper, a regulatory analysis for your jurisdiction, or a post on what your current field gets wrong about AI.

One artifact does more for you than ten applications.

Reframing Senior Professional Experience.

	The Trap	The Truth
The Asset	Making yourself smaller in writing to fit what you think the field wants.	Your background is not a deficit . If you've run a legal team, newsroom, or hospital ward, you bring standards of practice this forming field lacks.
The Move	Believing you are executing a "Career Change" and starting from zero.	It is a " Domain Change ." You already know risk registers, audit trails, and compliance failures. You only lack technical vocabulary (months of reading, not years of retraining).
The Credential	Waiting for a credential to act.	There is no settled credential. The IAPP is building certification precisely because the profession lacks qualified people. It is a gap being filled, not a gate you failed to pass.

The Missing Gender Data in AI

Hires into non-AI roles (LinkedIn, Aug 2026)

– Roughly half were women.

AI Hires (LinkedIn, Aug 2026)

– 26% women overall. Only 13% of AI C-suite roles.

AI Governance

– Half of these professionals sit in ethics, compliance, privacy or legal teams (IAPP 2025). Those functions have run closer to gender balance than ML engineering.

NO DATA

No published gender breakdown from IAPP, WEF, or Safety Institutes.

This is an **unmeasured field**. It is a concrete, unclaimed piece of work sitting on the table.

Visibility Flywheel

Answer in public
(Write answers where anyone can "find them; it scales.)

Present once
(Forces a piece of work, a recording, and a credential in one go.)

Publish one artifact
(Not a portfolio. One.)

Visibility is not self-promotion. It is being findable by the people who need what you know.

The Evidence

23 of 42 club sessions were led non-organizers.
(e.g., Tiffa Foster and Karen Maria Alston attended as participants, then asked to present).
They came, and then they asked.

22 made 42 possible.

Twenty-two people came to session three. That is the session that made session forty-two possible, and at the time it did not look like anything at all. You will not feel the moment it starts working. You will only notice, later, that it did.

Action Block

Thursdays, 17:00 UTC.
Free, no application.

Do one thing today. Come, ask, or write something down and share.